

TAKEOUT DOUBLES

East opens 1♣, 1♦, 1♥, or 1♠. South — sitting next — makes a takeout double, asking partner to bid an unbid suit.

A takeout double is:

- 12-18 HCP
- Shortness in opener's suit (typically 0-2 cards)
- 3+ cards in each unbid suit, ideally 4+ in any unbid major
- Distributional hands work too: 4-4-4-1 with shortness in opener's suit

is the classic "perfect" shape

It is NOT a penalty double — partner is expected to bid, not pass.

After the double, partner (advancer) responds:

- Bid a suit (length-priority: any unbid major if 4+, else 3+ minor)
- 1NT — 6-9 HCP with stoppers in opener's suit
- Cuebid opener's suit — 11+ HCP, forcing to game

For beginners: count HCP, count shape, check shortness in opener's suit.

Reference: https://www.bridgebum.com/takeout_double.php 4NT is Blackwood, asking for aces, or quantitative (inviting 6NT) after a natural notrump bid. Responses:

- 5♣ = 0 or 4 aces
- 5♦ = 1 ace
- 5♥ = 2 aces
- 5♠ = 3 aces
- 5NT then asks for kings the same way